

Final Summary: What Customers Want in a Chocolate Truffle

Phase 1: Collecting the Survey Data

A survey was run to learn what makes people choose one chocolate truffle over another. In total, 44 customers took part, and each person answered 24 short questions. In every question four options were shown, and the most preferred one was picked, with the choice to buy nothing at all. This produced 1,055 real choices and around 3,200 truffle options viewed, covering 61 different truffle types. Every truffle was described by five features: flavor, filling, size, whether it had superfoods, and price. Because real trade offs had to be made between the options, the choices reveal what customers truly care about, not just what they say they like.

Phase 2: Exploring the Data

Before any model was built, the basic patterns in the choices were examined.

- People wanted to buy. A truffle was picked about 80 percent of the time, and the no purchase option was chosen only about 20 percent of the time, which shows there is real demand.
- Price clearly shaped choices. As price went up, fewer people chose to buy. At 5.99 euro about 42 percent bought, at 6.99 euro about 28 percent, and at 7.99 euro only about 11 percent.
- Some features stood out early as more popular than others, which pointed toward a deeper model to measure exactly how much each one mattered.

Phase 3: Measuring What Drives the Choice

A customer choice model was then built. This model reads all the choices that were made and works out how important each feature is, how much money each feature is worth to customers, and which truffle would sell best.

1. Which Features Matter Most

- Size was the most important feature by far, driving about 42 percent of the decision. The 15g size was liked most, and the largest 20g size was strongly disliked.
- Price was the second most important feature, at about 29 percent.
- Superfoods mattered next, at about 16 percent, and truffles that had them were clearly preferred.
- Flavor came after that, at about 12 percent, with nutty as the favorite.
- Filling barely mattered at all, at about 1 percent, so the type of filling made almost no difference.

2. What Customers Will Pay

- Superfoods was the most valuable single feature. Customers would pay about 1.12 euro more for a truffle that has it.
- A nutty flavor was worth about 0.67 euro more than the standard fruity option.

- Other choices, like mixed flavor or liquid filling, added almost no extra value, so they are not worth spending money on.

3. The Best Truffle to Sell

- A range of truffles was tested to see which would win the most customers.
- The clear winner was a small, nutty truffle with superfoods. It took the largest share of customers, about 24 percent, even though it carried the highest price tested at 7.50 euro.
- This shows that the right mix of features can command a higher price and still come out on top.

Overall Insight

The study shows that customers care most about getting the right size, then a fair price, and they place real value on superfoods and a nutty flavor. Filling and most other flavors hardly affect the choice. The best approach is to build a small truffle around 15g, add superfoods, lead with nutty flavor, and avoid the large 20g size. Done well, these features support a premium price while still winning the most customers. In short, choosing the right features matters more than simply lowering the price.